

ORF309/MAT380

Lifetimes I:

Definitions & Series Connections

(pp. 77-84)

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Agenda for today

- Lifetime of components and devices
- Definitions
- Hazard function
- Hazard rate
- Connecting Lifetimes

Definitions

- The term **Lifetime** is perhaps the most important **random variable** of our **lifetime**...
- **Everything has a Lifetime** → $L =$ "the elapsed time until the occurrence of a specific event"
(failure, death, etc.)
 - Humans, Cars, Houses, Electronics, Wealth, Power, Friendships, ...
- The values of Lifetime can vary
 - L is a **Continuous RV**
 - Has values: $0 < L < \infty$ (the Definition of Lifetime)
 - Has **distribution (CDF)**: $F(t) = P\{L \leq t\}$, and the **time** is **continuous** $t \in [0, \infty)$
 - **The probability that something dies (or fails) by time t is very useful to know**

Definitions

- It is more convenient to think of the probability:

$$P\{L > t\} =$$

Shifting perspective:

- From probability of failure
- To probability of survival

- The probability that something *survives* (or *lasts*) beyond time t (aka, *Survival function*)

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- Two very important functions
 - $H(t)$: the (Cumulative) **Hazard function**
 - $h(t)$: the **hazard rate**

They both provide a way to mathematically describe the **deterioration of survival probability as time increases.**

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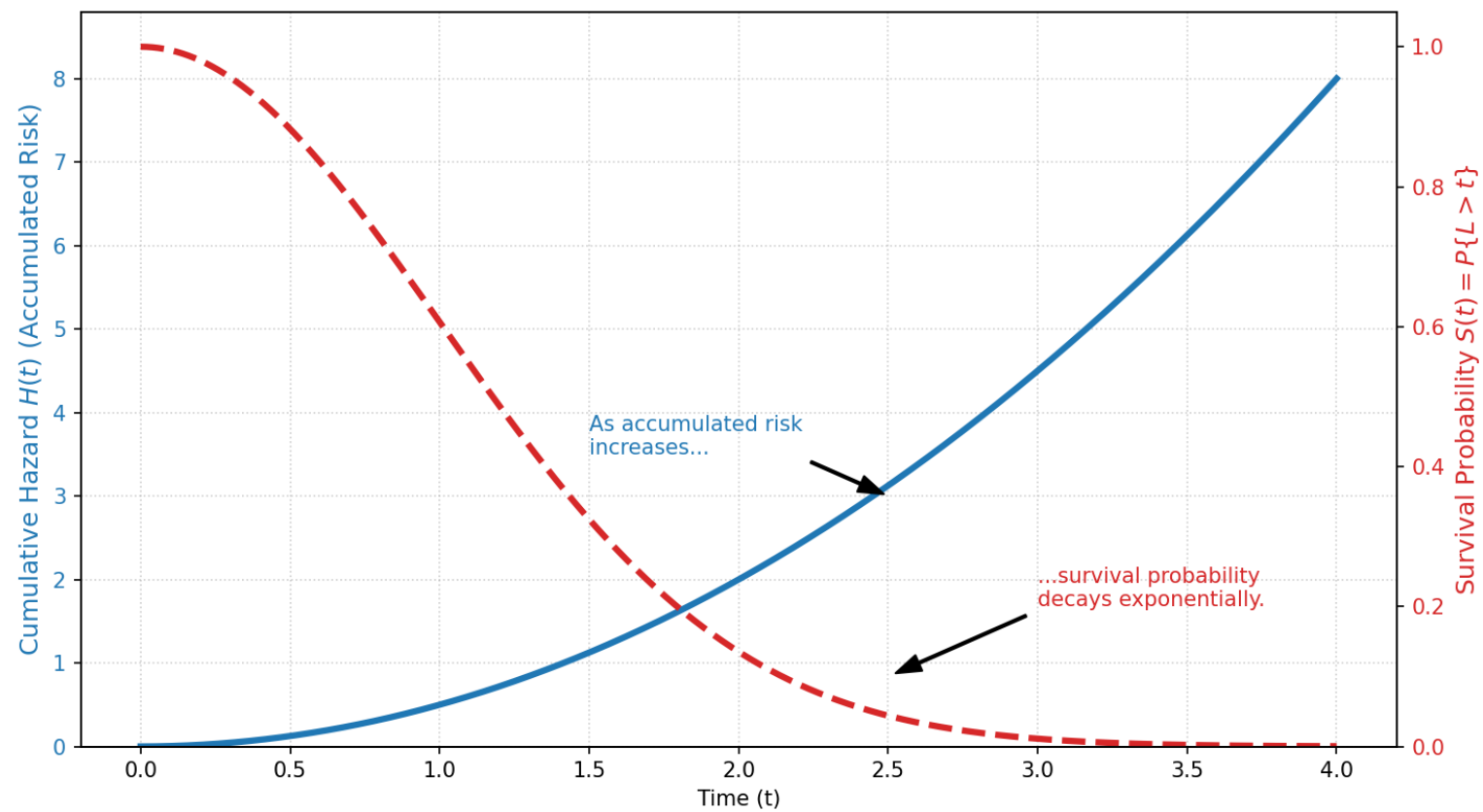
$$H(t) = \int_0^t h(s) ds$$

- **Bridge between the two**

$$P\{L > t\} = e^{-H(t)} = e^{-\int_0^t h(s) ds}$$

The probability of survival is **exponentially decaying** as the **total accumulated risk $H(t)$ increases**.

The Bridge: Cumulative Hazard vs. Survival Probability



Properties of Hazard function and hazard rate

- **Properties of Hazard functions $H(t)$:**

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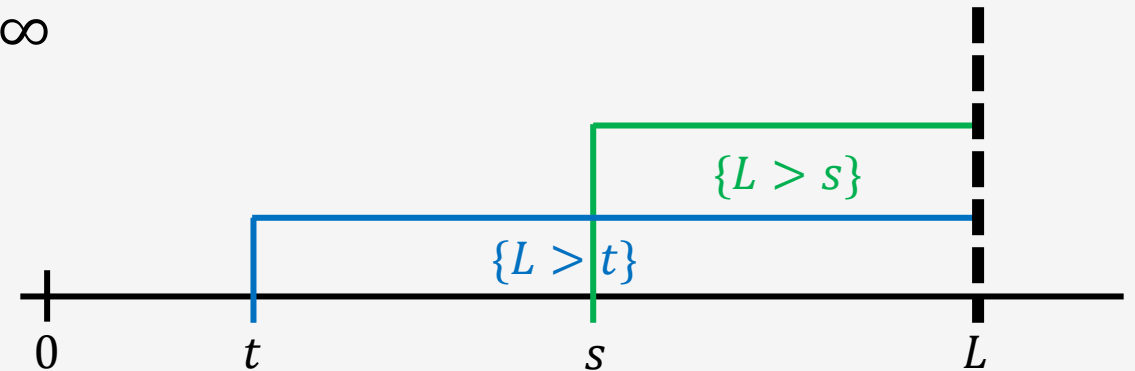
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3. $H(t)$ is an **increasing** function

Risk builds up as we age

- Take any $t < s$. Then

$$\{L > s\} \subset \{L > t\} \Rightarrow P\{L > s\} < P\{L > t\} \Rightarrow e^{-H(s)} < e^{-H(t)} \Rightarrow H(t) < H(s)$$



Properties of Hazard function and hazard rate

- **Properties of the hazard rate $h(s)$**

- $H(t) = \int_0^t h(s)ds \rightarrow h(s) = \frac{d}{ds}H(s)$ (fundamental theorem of Calculus)
- We know: $H(t)$ is increasing $\rightarrow h(s) \geq 0$ (nonnegative)
- Since $H(\infty) = \infty \rightarrow \int_0^\infty h(s)ds = \infty$ (the integral diverges)

Properties of Hazard function and hazard rate

- **Interpretation**

- The Hazard function appears in: $P\{L > t\} = e^{-H(t)}$
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$$P\{H^{-1}(X) > t\} = P\{X > H(t)\} = e^{-H(t)} = P\{L > t\}$$

- So, **L has the same distribution as $H^{-1}(X)$**

Inverse function - *refresher*

Example 1:

Consider a function that converts temperature from Celsius (C) to Fahrenheit (F)

$$F = f(C) = \frac{9}{5}C + 32$$

The inverse function, $C = f^{-1}$, should convert Celsius to Fahrenheit

$$C = f^{-1}(F) = \frac{5}{9}(F - 32)$$

Example 2:

Consider the function: $y = f(x) = e^{-\lambda x}$. We will find its inverse function $x = f^{-1}(y)$

$$\ln(y) = \ln(e^{-\lambda x}) \Rightarrow \ln(y) = -\lambda x \Rightarrow x = -\frac{1}{\lambda} \ln(y) \Rightarrow f^{-1}(y) = -\frac{1}{\lambda} \ln(y)$$

Properties of Hazard function and hazard rate

Interpretation: [Example for better understanding](#)

- X = "total # of **cigarettes** a person can smoke in their lifetime"

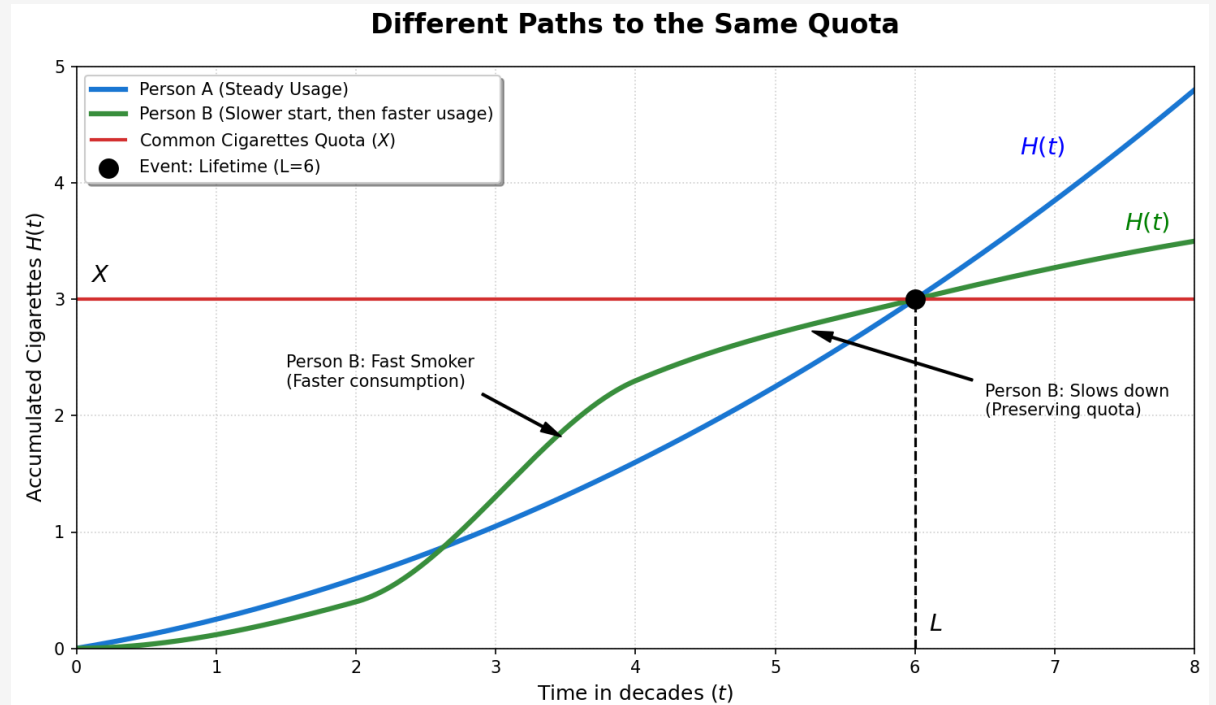
- Different for everyone $\rightarrow X \sim \text{Expon}(1)$

- $H(t)$ = "# of **cigarettes** used up to time t "

- How fast he consume his **cigarettes**

- L = "time when he use all his **cigarettes**"

- Once he reaches L , he dies $\rightarrow L = H^{-1}(X)$
(he reached his lifetime)



Will you make it another day...?

- **Question:** given you made to t years old, will you leave another u years?

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$$P\{L > t + u | L > t\} = \frac{P\{L > t + u, L > t\}}{P\{L > t\}} = \frac{P\{L > t + u\}}{P\{L > t\}} =$$

$$= \frac{e^{-\int_0^{t+u} h(s)ds}}{e^{-\int_0^t h(s)ds}} = e^{-\int_0^{t+u} h(s)ds + \int_0^t h(s)ds} = e^{-\int_t^{t+u} h(s)ds}$$

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$$P\{L \leq t + u | L > t\} =$$

You *will not* make it another day

- **Question:** given you made to t years old, will you die in the next u years?

$$P\{L \leq t + u | L > t\} = 1 - P\{L > t + u | L > t\} = 1 - e^{-\int_t^{t+u} h(s) ds}$$

Now define:

$$F_t(u) = 1 - e^{-\int_t^{t+u} h(s) ds}$$

and note:

$$F_t(0) = 0$$

You will not make it another day

Let's see what happens at the **limit**:

$$\lim_{u \rightarrow 0} \frac{P\{L \leq t + u | L > t\}}{u} = \lim_{u \rightarrow 0} \frac{1 - e^{-\int_t^{t+u} h(s) ds}}{u} = \lim_{u \rightarrow 0} \frac{1 - e^{-\int_t^{t+u} h(s) ds} - 0}{u} =$$

$$\lim_{u \rightarrow 0} \frac{F_t(u) - F_t(0)}{u} = - \left. \frac{d}{du} e^{-\int_t^{t+u} h(s) ds} \right|_{u=0} = h(t)$$

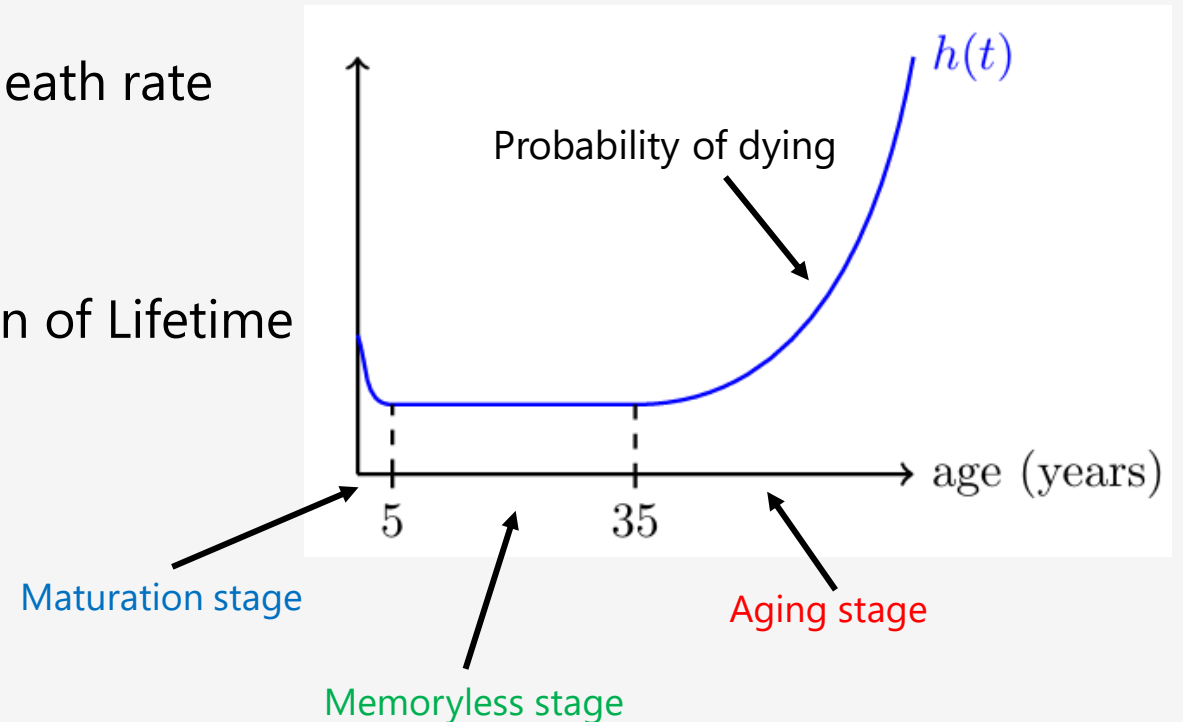
Hence, we have shown:

$$P\{L \leq t + \Delta t | L > t\} \approx h(t) \Delta t$$

Remark: that the hazard rate $h(t)$ can be thought of as the probability of death after Δt years, given that we made it to t years old. → Insurance and Healthcare companies are interested in this!

Graph of Human's hazard rate

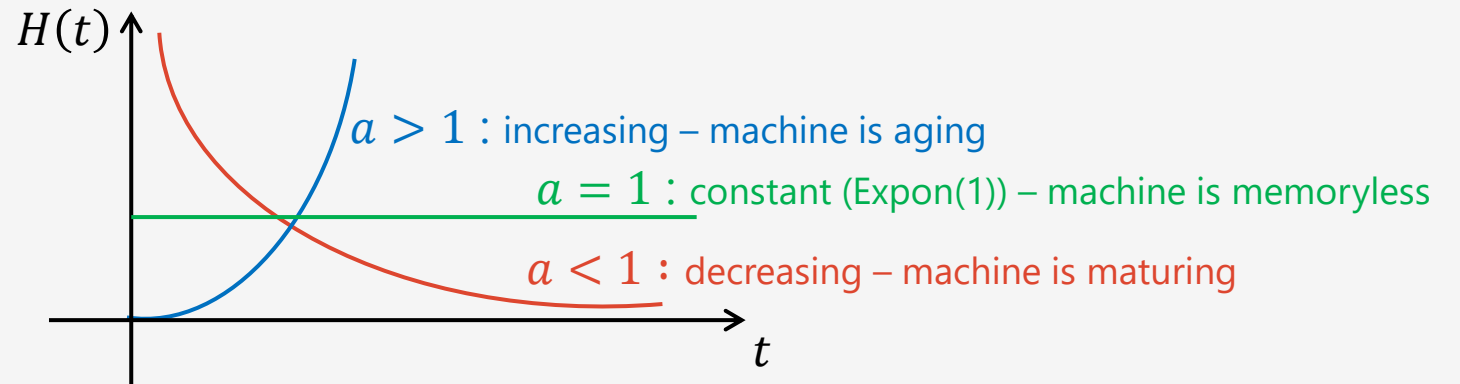
- Infants are vulnerable and have elevated rate of death
- Kids and young humans have the lowest death rate
- As humans grow older than 35-40 years the death rate accelerates
- Hazard rate describes naturally the distribution of Lifetime
 - **Maturation**: when $h(t)$ decreasing
 - **Memoryless**: when $h(t) \approx \text{constant}$
 - **Aging**: when $h(t)$ increasing



Weibull distribution

- **Example 2:**
 - Very useful distribution that can model **Aging**, **Maturation** and **Memoryless** regimes in Lifetimes

$$P\{L > t\} = e^{-\mu t^a} \quad H(t) = \mu t^a \quad h(t) = \frac{d}{dt} H(t) = a\mu t^{a-1} \quad a, \mu > 0$$



Connecting Lifetimes

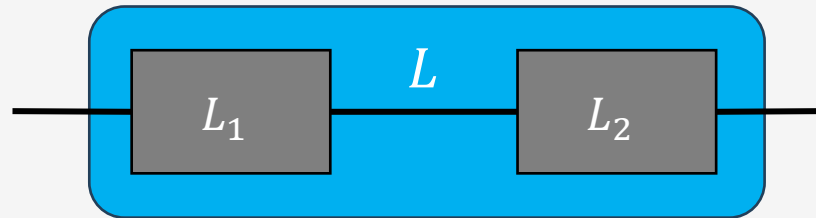
- Connecting Lifetimes is not very applicable to **humans**, (we after may have only one Life; maybe not...) but it is very important for mechanical and electronic **devices**.
 - Many components with different Lifetimes are connected together.
 - What is the Lifetime of the resulting device?
- The **types of connectivity** plays an important role
 - **Serial connectivity**
 - **Parallel connectivity**

Connecting Lifetimes – *modeling assumptions*

- **Modeling assumptions**
- L_i = Lifetime of **component** $i = 1,2$
 - $L_1 \perp\!\!\!\perp L_2$
 - H_i = Hazard function component $i = 1,2$
- L = Lifetime of the **device**
 - $L = \min\{L_1, L_2\} = L_1 \wedge L_2$ **OR** $L = \max\{L_1, L_2\} = L_1 \vee L_2$

Two components connected in series

$$L = \min\{L_1, L_2\} = L_1 \wedge L_2$$



What is the Hazard function H of the device?

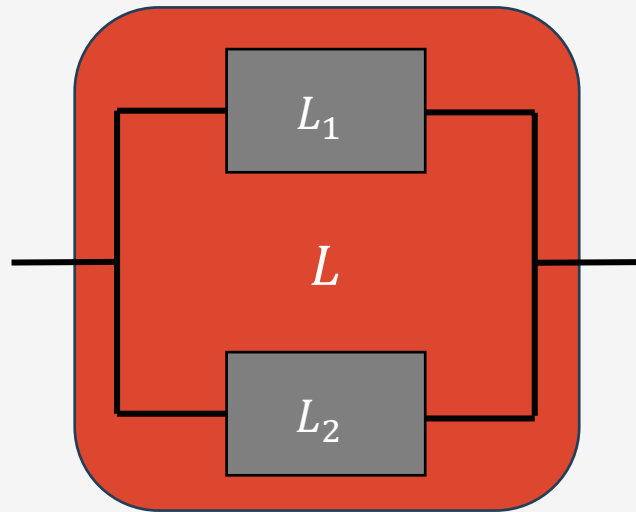
$$\begin{aligned} e^{-H(t)} &= P\{L > t\} = P\{L_1 \wedge L_2 > t\} = \\ &= P\{L_1 > t, L_2 > t\} = \boxed{L_1} \\ &= P\{L_1 > t\}P\{L_2 > t\} = \\ &= e^{-H_1(t)}e^{-H_2(t)} = \\ &= e^{-(H_1(t)+H_2(t))} \Rightarrow \\ &H(t) = H_1(t) + H_2(t) \end{aligned}$$

Remark: If $X \sim \text{Expon}(\mu)$ and $Y \sim \text{Expon}(\nu)$

then $\min\{X, Y\} = X \wedge Y \sim \text{Expon}(\mu + \nu)$

Two components connected in parallel

$$L = \mathbf{max}\{L_1, L_2\} = L_1 \vee L_2$$



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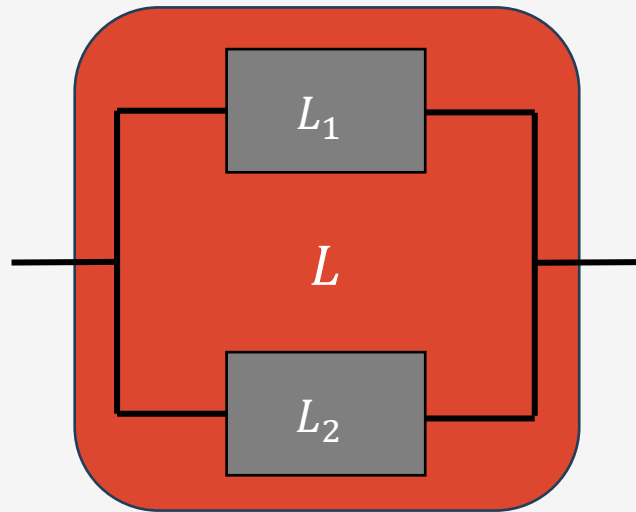
$$\begin{aligned} e^{-H(t)} &= P\{L > t\} = 1 - P\{L \leq t\} = \\ &= 1 - P\{L_1 \vee L_2 \leq t\} = \\ &= 1 - P\{L_1 \leq t, L_2 \leq t\} = \\ &= 1 - P\{L_1 \leq t\}P\{L_2 \leq t\} = \\ &= 1 - (1 - e^{-H_1(t)})(1 - e^{-H_2(t)}) \Rightarrow \end{aligned}$$

$$H(t) = -\log\left(1 - (1 - e^{-H_1(t)})(1 - e^{-H_2(t)})\right)$$

Remark: If $X \sim \text{Expon}(\mu)$ and $Y \sim \text{Expon}(\nu)$
then $X \vee Y$ is **NOT** Exponential

Two components connected in parallel

$$L = \max\{L_1, L_2\} = L_1 \vee L_2$$



What is the **Expected Lifetime** of the device?

Note: $\forall x_1, x_2 \in R, x_1 \vee x_2 = x_1 + x_2 - x_1 \wedge x_2 \Leftrightarrow$

$\Leftrightarrow \forall x_1, x_2 \in R, \max\{x_1, x_2\} = x_1 + x_2 - \min\{x_1, x_2\}$

$$\begin{aligned} E[L] &= E[L_1 \vee L_2] = \\ &= E[L_1 + L_2 - L_1 \wedge L_2] = \\ &= E[L_1] + E[L_2] - E[L_1 \wedge L_2] \end{aligned}$$

Remark: If $L_1 \sim \text{Expon}(\mu)$ and $L_2 \sim \text{Expon}(\nu)$

$$E[L] = \frac{1}{\mu} + \frac{1}{\nu} - \frac{1}{\mu + \nu}$$

Appendix

Example

Assume a machine has constant hazard rate, say $h(t) = \lambda$,

Note: this machine does not age! $\rightarrow$ The risk of failure at time $t = 0$ is the same as at $t = 1000$.

Question 1: What is the cumulative Hazard function $H(s)$?

Answer:

$$H(t) = \int_0^t \lambda ds \Rightarrow H(t) = \lambda t$$

Question 2: What is the Survival function: $S(t) = P\{L > t\}$?

Answer:

$$S(t) = P\{L > t\} = e^{-H(t)} = e^{-\lambda t}$$

It represents the survival function of an exponential RV.
It shows how the probability of staying operational decays over time!

Note also: $P\{L \leq t\} = 1 - P\{L > t\} = 1 - e^{-\lambda t}$